

Lords of Scotland

In Lords of Scotland, players have five rounds in which to prepare for a skirmish by mustering the clans. Once the fifth round is completed, the skirmish is resolved & players claim supporter (score) cards based upon the order in which they finished (highest to lowest). Skirmishes are played until one player has accumulated 40 points & is declared the winner.

Set Up

1. At the start of the game, give the "Victor's Initiative" card to the oldest player.
(In set up for subsequent skirmishes, the player who won the previous skirmish takes this card.)
2. New players are advised to remove the two Bruce Clan cards.
3. Shuffle the cards.
4. Deal each player five cards.
5. Create a row of five face-down cards. These form the "Recruit Pile".
6. Create a row of face-up cards equal to the number of players. These form the "Supporter Pile".
(If all supporter cards are of the same value, discard them & refresh the "Support Pile".)
7. The remaining cards form a "Draw Pile".
(If the "Draw Pile" is ever emptied, all discarded cards are shuffled & used to create a new "Draw Pile".)

Game Play

Preparation for the Skirmish

Players have five rounds to prepare for the up and coming skirmish.

For each round,

1. The player with the "Victor's Initiative" card turns one of the face-down "Recruit Pile" cards face-up at the start of each of his turns. This serves as an indicator of the current round number.
2. Starting with the owner of the "Victor's Initiative" card, player's take turns in a clockwise direction.
On their turn, each player has two options,
 - a. **Recruit a Clan** from the "Recruit Pile".
(Only available if the player has less than ten cards in their hand.)
 - i. The player takes a card from the "Recruit Pile" and adds it to their hand.
 - ii. Refresh the "Recruit Pile" by drawing a card from the "Draw Pile" & placing it in the "Recruit Pile" in the same way as the card that was taken (i.e. face-up/face-down).
 - b. **Mustering a Clan** by placing a card from the player's hand to the area in front of the player.
The value of the clan is added to the player's army value for the up and coming skirmish.
The card can be placed in one of two ways,
 - i. Face-Up – if the played card has a value (strength) that is lower than any other face-up card that is involved in the skirmish, the player can make use of the clan's power.
(In four and five player games, a clan's power can be activated if its value is less than any other face-up card of the same bloodline).
 - ii. Face-Down – no further action occurs.

Resolving the Skirmish

Once all players have finished their fifth turn, the skirmish is resolved.

1. Each player reveals their played cards & adds their values together to determine their army's strength.
2. If the player has played more than one clan & all clans of a player's army are of the same bloodline, the value of the army is doubled.
3. In case of a tie, the value of the highest ranked clan is used to determine the victor.
4. From highest valued army to lowest, each player takes one of the cards from the "Supporter Pile" as their score for this skirmish and adds it to their victory pile.
 - a. A player's army must have at least one clan to claim a supporter card.
 - b. If all supporter cards have already been claimed, no further supporter cards are available.
5. The highest placed player takes the "Victor's Initiative" card.
6. Discard all cards in the "Recruit Pile", "Supporter Pile" & cards that players used to build their army.
7. Rebuild the "Recruit Pile" & the "Supporter Pile" (refer to steps 5 & 6 of Set Up).
(Note: players do not receive any new cards at the set up for the next round.)

End of Game

Once a player has accumulated 40 or more points in their victory pile, they are declared the winner.

In the event of a tie, the player who placed higher in the final skirmish wins.

Lords of Scotland ~ Bloodline Powers

Each bloodline has its own power. The following rules apply to their use.

1. The clan card must be played face-up to the player's army.
2. The value (strength) of the played clan card must be less than the value of any other clan already played face-up in the current skirmish.
 - In a four or five player game, the value of the played clan card must be less than the value of any other clan **of the same bloodline** already played face-up in the current skirmish.
3. The clan's bloodline power is only activated when it is played (i.e. the power does not become active when it is obtained through a swap).

Preparation for the Skirmish Powers

These powers take place immediately.

Bloodline Power	Description
<i>Discard a Clan</i>	Discard one of the clans (face-up or face-down) from any player's army in the current skirmish.
<i>Swap with another Clan</i>	Swap the played clan with any other clan (face-up or face-down) from any player's army in the current skirmish. The swapped card's orientation (face-up/face-down) must be retained.
<i>Muster another Clan</i>	The player plays another clan from their hand into their army.
<i>Copy another power</i>	Copy the power of any face-up clan from any player's army in the current skirmish. (Note: if the power being copied is one that is resolved at the end of the skirmish, coloured token/meeples could be used to indicate the association between the card that is copying & the cards that is being copied.)
<i>Draw a Card</i>	Draw a card from the "Draw Pile" into the player's hand.
<i>Swap with a Supporter</i>	Swap the played clan with any of the clans in the "Supporter Pile". The swapped card is placed face-up in the player's army.

Resolving the Skirmish Powers

These powers take place when or after the skirmish is resolved.

These powers are valid for the player who owns the clan at the end of the skirmish.

Bloodline Power	Description
<i>Join each Bloodline</i> (Clan Bruce cards)	When the value (strength) of the player's army is being determined, the bloodline of the Clan Bruce card is ignored & it becomes a wildcard.
<i>Claim two Supporters</i>	When the player is claiming his supporter, he can claim two supporter cards. If all supporter cards have already been claimed, no further supporter cards are drawn.
<i>Do not discard this Clan</i>	Once the skirmish has been resolved, this card remains face-up in front of the player for the next skirmish. This only occurs for the skirmish that follows the one in which it was originally played. It may be worthwhile turning the card sideways to indicate that it has been carried over from the previous skirmish.